

Incident report analysis

Summary	The company experienced a security event when all network services suddenly stopped responding. A flood of incoming ICMP packets caused the incident, and the team identified it as a distributed denial of services (DDoS) attack. The team responded by blocking the attack and stopping all non-critical network services to prioritize restoring critical network services.
Identify	A malicious actor or actors targeted the company with an ICMP flood attack. The entire internal network was affected. All critical network resources needed to be secured and restored to a functioning state.
Protect	The cybersecurity team implemented a new firewall rule to limit the rate of incoming ICMP packets. Source IP address verification on the firewall to check spoofed IP addresses on incoming ICMP packets. Network monitoring software is installed to detect abnormal activity, using an IDS/IPS system to filter ICMP traffic based on suspicious characteristics.
Detect	To detect unauthorized access attacks in the future, the cybersecurity team will use the source IP verification, in tandem with the implemented network monitoring system, to detect abnormal traffic patterns.
Respond	For future security events, the cybersecurity team will isolate affected systems to prevent continued disruption to the network. They will attempt to restore the critical systems and services that were damaged by the event. Then, the team will analyze network logs to check for any suspicious and abnormal activity. The team will also report all incidents to upper management and legal authorities, when applicable.
Recover	To recover from the DDoS attack by ICMP flooding, access to network services needs to be restored to baseline functionality. In the future, external ICMP flood attacks can be blocked by the firewall before they breach the internal network.

	Then, all non-critical network services should be stopped to reduce internal network traffic. Next, critical network services are to be restored first. Finally, once the flood of ICMP packets has timed out, all non-critical network systems and services can be brought back online.
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